

Investment Radar

User Guide

A plain-English walkthrough of everything the Radar does, what each number means, and how to use it day-to-day. Written for Frank Grant — no coding required.



Grade bands — the traffic-light scoring used everywhere in the app.

Generated 2026-07-07
github.com/frankgrant333-hue/Investment_Radar

Contents

1. What the Radar is for
 2. Starting the dashboard (on your Mac)
 3. Adding a new ticker
 4. Reading the main table
 5. How Value Score works
 6. How Tech Score works
 7. How Composite Score works
 8. How to read the grade letters
 9. Clicking any ticker for the full breakdown
 10. Refresh fundamentals
 11. Snapshots (looking back in time)
 12. Filters, deletions, and edits — the save flow
 13. The phone view (Streamlit Cloud)
 14. Sync workflow — one-line summary
 15. Where things live
 16. If something breaks
 17. Not investment advice
- Appendix A: Sample dashboard view

1. What the Radar is for

A single place to capture every investment idea you hear about (from podcasts, YouTube, friends, articles), automatically fill in the boring metadata, score each one on two dimensions, and rank them all in a table you can scan in under a minute.

Two goals:

- **Fill your knowledge gaps.** You never have to know what sector NVDA is in — the Radar pulls that from Yahoo Finance.
- **Rank ideas honestly.** Every ticker gets a numeric score, so you can compare AMD vs. NVDA vs. TSLA without leaning on gut feel or hype.

The Radar is a **thinking aid**, not a recommendation engine. It tells you what the numbers say. You still decide what to buy.

2. Starting the dashboard (on your Mac)

Every time you want to work with the Radar, follow these steps. Takes about 30 seconds after the first time.

Step by step

- **Open Terminal.** Press Command+Space, type "Terminal", hit Enter.
- **Move into the project folder:**

```
cd ~/Investment_Radar
```

- **Turn on the virtual environment.** This makes sure Python uses the exact libraries the Radar was built with.

```
source venv/bin/activate
```

You should see **(venv)** appear at the start of your prompt. That's how you know it worked.

- **Launch the dashboard:**

```
streamlit run radar/app.py --server.port 9000
```

Chrome opens a new tab at **http://localhost:9000**. First load takes 15–30 seconds because the Radar fetches fresh data from Yahoo for every ticker.

- **When you're done**, come back to Terminal and press **Control+C**. That stops the server. Then close Terminal.

If something goes wrong

- **"venv/bin/activate: No such file"** — you're not in the right folder. Run `cd ~/Investment_Radar` again.

- **"Streamlit: command not found"** — you forgot the activate step. Re-run source `venv/bin/activate`.
- **Browser shows "This site can't be reached"** — wait a few more seconds; Streamlit is still booting.

3. Adding a new ticker (Mac dashboard only)

You can only add tickers from your Mac dashboard, not the phone view. The sidebar on the left is where the add form lives.

Two-step add

- **Type the symbol** in the "Ticker symbol" box. Case doesn't matter. For US stocks use the plain symbol (NVDA, AAPL). For crypto, the short form works — the Radar knows that BTC means Bitcoin, ETH means Ethereum.
- **Click "Look up info"**. The Radar hits Yahoo Finance and pulls the full company name, sector, industry, asset type, and a one-sentence description.
- **If Yahoo found it**, a preview appears under the button. Fill in the **Theme** field — this is *your* thesis tag, like [AI](#), [Nuclear Energy](#), [Dividend Play](#). Comma-separate multiple. Optionally add Source (where you heard about it) and Notes.
- **Click "Add to radar"** and the ticker appears in your table below.

Deleting or editing tickers

- **Delete a row**: hover over it in the table, click the trash icon that appears on the left of the row, then click **Save changes** below the table.
- **Edit theme, source, or notes**: click any cell in those columns, type, then click **Save changes**.
- **Edit things Yahoo got wrong** (like NVDA's sector being mislabelled): flip on **Edit metadata mode** above the table. The name, sector, sub_sector, asset_type, and description columns become editable. Fix what you need, click Save changes, then flip Edit mode back off so you don't accidentally overwrite something later.

4. Reading the main table

From left to right, the columns are:

Column	What it means
★	Star appears when BOTH Value Score AND Tech Score are ≥ 70 . The academic sweet spot: Qu
current_price	Most recent daily closing price from Yahoo. Not live intraday.
past_30d_price	Closing price 30 trading days ago (~6 calendar weeks). Eyeball vs current for recent trajectory.
symbol	The ticker Yahoo recognises. BTC-USD for Bitcoin, NVDA for NVIDIA, etc.
composite_score	The headline number: 0–100. Higher is better.

composite_grade	Letter grade (colour-coded) for the composite.
value_score	0–100 from 5 fundamentals: debt/equity, current ratio, net cash %, ROE, FCF yield. Higher = stronger.
value_grade	Letter grade for value.
tech_score	0–100 from 4 price-action signals: Stage 2, 20-day-high proximity, RS vs SPY, ATR sweet spot.
tech_grade	Letter grade for tech.
name / asset_type / sector / subsector	Classification data. Broad → narrow.
theme	YOUR thesis tag. Comma-separate multiple.
source	Where you heard about the ticker.
notes	Anything else worth remembering.
description	One-sentence company summary from Yahoo.
date_added	Auto-set when the row is created.

Sorting

- By default the table is **sorted by composite_score, highest first**. The best-ranked idea is always at the top.
- **Click any column header** to re-sort by that column. Click again to reverse.
- **Group by sector** (toggle above the table) clusters all tickers in the same sector together, then sub-sectors within that, then composite within that.

Filtering

Click the **Filter the radar** expander above the table to narrow what's shown. Sector, theme, and asset-type filters can be combined. There's also a checkbox to **show only Quality + Momentum picks** (the ★ rows). Filters affect the table AND the per-ticker charts. Clearing all selections shows everything again.

5. How Value Score works

Five metrics, each scored 0–100. The Value Score is the simple average of the five sub-scores. Any sub-score that couldn't be computed (missing data) is **dropped from the average, not zeroed**.

Metric	What it measures	Score = 100	Score = 0
Debt / Equity	Leverage (lower safer)	≤ 0.25	≥ 2.0
Current Ratio	Short-term assets vs bills	≥ 2.5	≤ 1.0
Net Cash % of MC	$(\text{Cash} - \text{Debt}) / \text{Market Cap} \times 100$	$\geq +25\%$	$\leq -25\%$
ROE %	Return on equity	$\geq 25\%$	$\leq 0\%$

FCF Yield %	FCF / Market cap	$\geq 10\%$	$\leq 0\%$
-------------	------------------	-------------	------------

Values between the two extremes scale linearly. A debt-to-equity of 1.1 (halfway between 0.25 and 2.0) scores about 50.

Value Score is stocks-only. ETFs and crypto have no fundamentals of the sort we're measuring, so they show **N/A** in the value_score column — by design, not a bug.

6. How Tech Score works

Four metrics, each scored 0–100. Tech Score is the simple average.

Metric	What it measures	Score = 100	Score = 0
Stage 2 trend	Price > 30-week MA & MA sloping up	True	False
% below 20d high	Distance below 20-day high	within 2%	> 20% below
RS vs SPY (90d)	Ticker return – SPY return, in pts	beat by ≥ 20 pts	lag by ≥ 20 pts
ATR %	Volatility sweet-spot band	2% – 5%	< 0.5% or > 10%

The ATR metric is a **band**, not a slope — too little volatility means dead money, too much means casino. The 2–5% band is where swing setups typically live.

Tech Score works for all asset types — stocks, ETFs, AND crypto — because it's derived only from price history.

7. How Composite Score works

$$\text{composite_score} = 0.5 \times \text{value_score} + 0.5 \times \text{tech_score}$$

Simple 50/50 blend. Two special cases:

- If **Value Score is N/A** (ETFs, crypto, or missing data), composite is just the Tech Score.
- If **both are N/A**, composite is N/A.

This is the number the table sorts by. It's also the number the ★ star uses — both Value and Tech must be ≥ 70 for the star to appear.

8. How to read the grade letters

Every 0–100 score maps to an A–F letter with a colour-coded circle in the app:

Score range	Grade	Meaning
85 – 100	A	Excellent — Top-tier. Rare. Worth a look.
70 – 84	B	Strong — Comfortably better than baseline.

50 – 69	C	Average — Neither green nor red flag.
25 – 49	D	Weak — Yellow flag. Investigate before sizing.
0 – 24	F	Poor — Red flag on this dimension.
—	N/A	Couldn't be computed (e.g. ETF Value Score).

Same bands apply to every score in the app — sub-scores, Value, Tech, Composite. So a Value Score of 78 reads as *Strong on fundamentals*. A Composite of 44 reads as *Weak overall* — *think twice*.

9. Clicking any ticker for the full breakdown

Below the table, each ticker gets its own expander (a collapsible section). Click any of them to see:

- **Full description** from Yahoo.
- **Value Score breakdown** — the raw numbers Yahoo reported (debt/equity, ROE, etc.) alongside each metric's sub-score.
- **Tech Score breakdown** — the raw numbers (Stage 2 boolean, ATR%, etc.) alongside each metric's sub-score.
- **1-year price chart**.
- **Quick stats**: latest close, 90-day-ago price, 90-day change %.

This is where you go when a ticker's headline score surprises you. If NVDA has a Composite B but you thought it should be A, the breakdown shows you which sub-scores dragged it down.

10. Refresh fundamentals

The **Refresh fundamentals** button clears the internal 30-minute cache and re-pulls every ticker from Yahoo. Use it:

- After a company's earnings release (fundamentals change).
- If a number looks wrong and you want a fresh read.
- Otherwise, let the cache do its work — every re-load of the page within 30 minutes is nearly instant.

11. Snapshots (looking back in time)

Click **Snapshot today** to save the current state of the Radar to a dated CSV in the snapshots/ folder. Every ticker's scores and prices get frozen for that day. Same-day clicks overwrite (you get the latest read of the day, not duplicates).

Below the per-ticker expanders, a **Past snapshots** section lets you pick any past date and see what your Radar looked like then.

Snapshots let you answer *Had NVDA been trending up in the weeks before I bought it?* — a question you can't ask the live view.

Automated daily snapshots (optional)

A macOS launchd job can auto-snapshot every morning at 8 AM so you don't have to remember. See the `Launchd/` folder — the plist file inside has install instructions in the comments.

12. Filters, deletions, and edits — the save flow

Any change you make in the table (edit a cell, delete a row) stays in the browser only until you click **Save changes**. Refreshing the page before saving throws away the edits.

Once you click Save, changes get written to `ideas.csv` in your `Investment_Radar` folder AND (if you set it up) your iCloud Drive copy. Both stay in sync automatically.

13. The phone view (Streamlit Cloud)

Once you've published your Radar to Streamlit Community Cloud (a one-time setup — see `PHONE_ACCESS_SETUP.md`), you can visit your dashboard from any phone or browser at **frank-investment-radar.streamlit.app**.

The phone view is read-only. You'll see:

- Same table, same scores, same charts.
- Sidebar says "Phone view — read only" instead of the add form.
- No Save, no Snapshot, no Edit toggle.

To update the phone view with new tickers or edits:

- Add/edit as usual on your Mac dashboard, click Save.
- Open **GitHub Desktop** — you'll see `ideas.csv` and `latest_metrics.csv` in the Changes panel.
- Type a short commit message ("Add MU" or whatever), click **Commit to main**, then **Push origin**.
- Wait about a minute. Streamlit Cloud auto-detects the new commit and rebuilds. Refresh your phone — new data is there.

Why scores work on Mac but not directly on phone

Yahoo Finance's fundamentals endpoint is rate-limited from cloud servers. Your Mac's home IP is fine. So the Mac dashboard fetches fresh fundamentals AND writes them to `latest_metrics.csv`. The phone view reads the CSV instead of calling Yahoo. Result: your phone always shows the scores your Mac last saw.

14. Sync workflow — one-line summary

Change on Mac	To reach phone
Added a ticker, saved	Push ideas.csv + latest_metrics.csv
Edited a theme, saved	Same
Deleted a row, saved	Same
Clicked Refresh fundamentals	Same (metrics changed)
Took a snapshot	Optional — push snapshots/*.csv

Basic rule: **any time you save on Mac, do a GitHub Desktop commit + push before you leave the house.** Then the phone view is fresh.

15. Where things live

```
~/Investment_Radar/
■■■■ radar/ # The Python code
■ ■■■■ app.py # The dashboard
■ ■■■■ load_data.py # Reads ideas.csv
■ ■■■■ lookup.py # Yahoo ticker lookup
■ ■■■■ fundamentals.py # Value-metric fetcher
■ ■■■■ technicals.py # Price + tech metric fetcher
■ ■■■■ scoring.py # All the math
■ ■■■■ latest_metrics.py # Mac→Cloud metric sync
■ ■■■■ snapshots.py # Daily snapshot CSVs
■ ■■■■ daily_snapshot.py # Headless CLI for schedule
■■■■ launchd/ # macOS auto-schedule plist
■■■■ snapshots/ # Dated CSV snapshots
■■■■ ideas.csv # YOUR WATCHLIST
■■■■ latest_metrics.csv # Auto-written scores for phone view
■■■■ requirements.txt # Python dependencies
■■■■ venv/ # Isolated Python setup (git-ignored)
■■■■ USER_GUIDE.md # This guide in Markdown
■■■■ USER_GUIDE.pdf # This guide as PDF
■■■■ README.md # High-level blurb
```

The only file you ever edit by hand is `ideas.csv` (and only through the dashboard's Save button — don't open it in Numbers while Streamlit is running).

16. If something breaks

- **Dashboard shows the wrong price for a crypto ticker** (e.g. BTC showing \$8 instead of \$67,000) — Yahoo probably matched your symbol to a trust product. Delete the row and re-add using BTC-USD explicitly, or edit the row's symbol via the Edit mode toggle.

- **Value Score shows N/A for a stock** — Yahoo may have stopped reporting a metric. Click Refresh fundamentals; if it's persistent, the company probably went private / delisted / had a corporate action.
- **Phone view is showing old data** — you forgot to push. Open GitHub Desktop, commit + push. Wait 60 seconds, refresh phone.
- **Streamlit dashboard won't open** — double-check the Terminal says **(venv)** and the command is `streamlit run radar/app.py --server.port 9000`.

17. Not investment advice

The Radar's numbers are a decision-support tool, not a recommendation. The scoring thresholds come from standard quality-investing literature (Buffett-style screens, Weinstein Stage Analysis, etc.), but past behavior is not future returns. Always do your own research before committing capital.

Appendix A: Sample dashboard view

A snapshot of Frank's actual radar as of the most recent run — with grades colour-coded exactly the way the live dashboard shows them. The ★ next to NVDA marks it as a Quality + Momentum pick (Value ≥ 70 AND Tech ≥ 70).

★	Price	30d Ago	Symbol	Comp	Grade	Value	Grade	Tech	Grade	Sector
	\$747.62	\$743.72	SPY	76	B	N/A	N/A	76	B	ETF
	\$28.22	\$33.53	BTC	49	D	N/A	N/A	49	D	ETF
	\$12.53	\$14.96	XRP	46	D	N/A	N/A	46	D	Stock
	\$21.06	\$29.40	QBTS	31	D	53	C	10	F	Tech
	\$16.55	\$26.42	RGTI	26	D	53	C	0	F	Tech
	\$306.13	\$253.84	IBM	74	B	N/A	N/A	74	B	Tech
★	\$196.93	\$215.33	NVDA	75	B	72	B	78	B	Tech
	\$516.11	\$467.51	AMD	67	C	59	C	75	B	Tech
	\$938.38	\$750.88	MU	61	C	72	B	50	C	Tech
	\$230.70	\$196.33	MRVL	57	C	64	C	50	C	Tech
	\$110.39	\$119.84	INTC	49	D	45	D	52	C	Tech
	\$11.66	\$16.35	INFQ	48	D	95	A	1	F	Tech

Notice the diversity of patterns: **NVDA** — the ideal case: both fundamentals and price action strong. **MU** — value B, tech only C, so the fundamentals say quality but the chart hasn't caught up. **INFQ** — value A but tech F: a classic value trap, cheap on paper but the market is telling you something.

That comparison — value vs tech, quality vs momentum — is the whole point of the Radar. The scores make patterns visible that eyeballing tickers can't.